Zero Cube Climate & Social Impact Foundation
A Section 8 people's company · From the people, for the people · CIN U88900PN2026NPL260913

MEMBERSHIP BENEFITS GUIDE · 2026–27

From the people, for the people

What membership means for you

Free learning for everyone, all 18 membership tiers (including three proposed education tiers), the benefits linked to your Climate Duty Pledge, AI-first and human-verified certification, the path from member to philanthropist, online networking, global benchmarks and how our assessments stay credible.

सदस्यत्वाचे लाभ — मराठी सारांश आत (पृष्ठ २१)

Net Zero
Scope 3, MSMEs and villages

SROI
Social value per ₹1, mapped to the SDGs

Quality Education
Schools, students and teachers

DRAFT for director review · 19 October 2026. Membership payments open soon, once our bank account is active. **No payment is collected now** — join the Founding Members waitlist on the membership page. Fees are exactly as on the current fee card (zerocube website, membership page). Existing fees are unchanged; three new education tiers (Education Champion, Student Sponsor, Green School Partner) are **Proposed**, with fees set from published benchmarks — Board to approve. Items marked **Planned** are not built yet; **Prototype** items are built and launch after setup. Legal points are marked "CS/CA to confirm". No 80G or 12A claim is made; membership fees are payments for services, not donations.

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From the people, for the people. Zero Cube is a Section 8 people's company. Our Board — Saurabh Somani and Rajendrakumar Saraf — are **philanthropists of time, expertise and networks**: they give these voluntarily and receive no remuneration. Directors do not fund the company (no loans, guarantees or liability). A director may take any membership tier at the normal fee (no special discount unless the Board approves it openly) or donate voluntarily; this is never a condition of being a director, is not a loan, gives no liability or control, is recorded in the register of interests and minutes, and is reviewed by our CS/CA. Donations go only to the Foundation's objects or directly to beneficiaries, and no director receives any benefit or preferential service in return.

Key points in one minute

- **Learning is free for everyone.** All webinars and Climate Academy online courses are free — no membership needed. Membership pays for deeper services (hands-on roles, members-only sessions, the Commitment Certificate, audits and assessments, networking and recognition), not for knowledge.
- **The Climate Duty Pledge is free** for everyone.
- **Every one of the 18 tiers** — paid, free, time-giving or Patron — unlocks the Commitment Certificate and Net Zero audit interest once your pledge is Approved and your membership is active (decided 18 Oct 2026).
- **Villages never pay and need no membership.** Village Net Zero certification is funded through CSR. CSR cannot be used to pay membership fees.
- **Zero Cube never takes a cut of giving.** Donors give directly to verified NPOs, students and schools.
- **Certification is AI-first, then a human verifier.** "Zero Cube assessed" means an assessment under our own criteria. Optional independent verification (an ISO 14065-accredited body) is paid directly to the verifier by MSMEs, or through CSR for villages — never a membership fee increase.
- **No fee increase.** Existing tiers keep their fees; the three new education tiers are proposed with low, researched fees (section 6).
- **Soft launch.** Membership payments open soon, once our bank account is active. **No payment is collected now** — join the Founding Members waitlist on the membership page.

Status labels used in this guide

Live on the website today Prototype built, launching after setup Planned not built yet Proposed tier tag shown on the fee card

1 How membership works

Membership is how individuals, businesses, schools, NPOs and villages join Zero Cube's measured work on Net Zero, SROI and Quality Education.

1 Take the pledge (free)

Sign the Climate Duty Pledge online. A moderator reviews it; once Approved it gets a pledge ID on the Pledge Ledger. Prototype

2 Choose a tier

Pick the tier that fits you from the 18 on the fee card. Join the Founding Members waitlist now (no payment). When payments open: confirm eligibility and fee → pay (invoice) → take part. Live waitlist

3 Link membership to your pledge

In My Pledge, link your membership by email or member ID. A moderator confirms the link. Prototype

4 Unlock pledge benefits

With an Approved pledge and an active membership of any tier, apply for the Commitment Certificate and register Net Zero audit interest. Prototype

Learn, then participate, then act

Step	What it means	Who
1 · Learn	Public webinars on Net Zero, SROI and education, and self-paced Climate Academy online courses.	Everyone, free
2 · Participate	Hands-on roles, members-only sessions twice a month, field work, campus chapters and online networking.	Members
3 · Act	Apply for the Commitment Certificate, register Net Zero audit interest, and earn recognition.	Members

Simple rules

- **No hidden add-ons.** Every fee covers what its fee card lists, with no commission. Optional independent verification is paid directly to the verifier, never to Zero Cube. Prices are before GST; some tiers are subject to Board approval.
- **Members-only sessions** run twice a month for paying tiers; public webinars stay free for everyone.
- **If membership lapses,** an issued Commitment Certificate stays valid as a record of your commitment on that date. Renewals and new requests need an active membership.
- **Fees are not donations.** They are payments for membership services. No 80G or 12A claim is made. INR from Indian sources only.
- **No payment now.** Membership payments open soon, once our bank account is active. **No payment is collected now** — join the Founding Members waitlist on the membership page.
- **Circle membership is not company membership** — joining a members' circle does not make you a member of the Section 8 company.

Where your fee goes: our promises

- Every rupee is applied only to our objects.
- No dividend or distribution is ever made; directors serve without remuneration.
- Spending follows income; directors give no loans or guarantees.

- Villages never pay.
- An annual transparency report will be published with our audited accounts, showing how income was actually received and applied.

CS/CA to confirm: GST on fees, the membership-vs-company-member distinction, and Board approval of proposed tiers before they are offered.

2 Pledge-linked benefits

Your Climate Duty Pledge is free. Membership turns it into something you can show and act on.

Commitment Certificate Prototype

A certificate with your pledge ID and a QR code that opens its own entry on the Pledge Ledger. Verifiable, at no extra fee for members of any tier.

It certifies a **commitment, not results**. Your progress updates are self-declared unless assessed.

Net Zero audit interest Prototype

From My Pledge, register interest in a Net Zero audit for your home, business, school or village. This is an expression of interest, not a booking or payment.

Fee **as per fee card**. **Villages never pay** — village certification is CSR-funded and needs no membership.

Wall of Honour Prototype

An opt-in public wall of approved pledges and members who choose to be listed.

Opens at launch; no entries yet. Minors: parent/guardian consent, first name only, no photos.

Pledge Ledger verification Prototype

Each Approved pledge gets an entry on a public, tamper-evident Pledge Ledger. Anyone — an employer, buyer or donor — can check it from the certificate QR code.

Records a pledge and its status; it does not certify emissions.

Who unlocks what

Situation	Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit interest
Pledge only (no membership)	Locked — "Unlocks when you become a Zero Cube member"	Locked
Approved pledge + active membership of any of the 18 tiers	Unlocked	Unlocked — fee as per fee card
Village (Gram Panchayat / certified club)	No membership needed; certified clubs and Gram Panchayats may join free as Certified Network Members	CSR route — no cost to the village, no membership needed
Membership expired	Issued certificate stays valid as a record; no new certificate	New requests need renewal

Decided: villages use the CSR route and need no membership (Certified Network membership stays optional and free). **CS/legal to confirm** the certificate and audit terms (draft terms version g).

3 The 18 tiers, one by one

Names, fees and benefits below are copied from the current fee card. “What it means for you” explains them in plain words. Every tier carries the pledge-linked benefits in the green strip.

TIER 1 · PEOPLE

Student / Youth Member

₹1,000 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

College students and youth climate volunteers (under 25); free for students in our school and village programmes (proposed)

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- All webinars and Climate Academy courses free (as for everyone)
- Active roles: Webinar Crew at public webinars, members-only post-webinar Action Labs
- Field Data Contributor, campus chapter, campus Net Zero challenge
- Publish session summaries and articles under your name
- Digital badges earned through your roles: Learner → Contributor → Champion
- Mentor circles, internship & volunteering introductions
- Bulletin and magazine

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Career: Real roles — Webinar Crew, Field Data Contributor, campus chapter — that you can show on a CV, plus published summaries and articles under your name.

Reputation: Digital badges (Learner → Contributor → Champion) and a verifiable Commitment Certificate for your pledge.

Impact: Field data you collect feeds real reports; your work is credited.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in only; for anyone under 18, a parent/guardian consents and only a first name is shown.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 2 · PEOPLE

Individual Supporter

₹2,500 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Professionals, citizens, alumni

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Supporter certificate and listing (opt-in)
- Bulletin and magazine with SROI and education updates
- Members-only sessions (2 a month)
- Invitation to the annual Climate & Social Impact meet

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Career: Members-only sessions twice a month keep you current on climate, SROI and education.

Reputation: A supporter certificate and an opt-in listing show you back measured climate and education work.

Impact: Your fee helps fund free public awareness that everyone can use.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 3 · BUSINESS

Startup Supporter

₹4,500 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Climate and impact startups

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Online video library
- Members-only sessions (2 a month), including startup clinics
- Bulletin and magazine

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Business: A video library and members-only sessions help you speak the language of Net Zero, Scope 3 and impact buyers.

Career: Members-only sessions connect founders with practitioners and peers.

Reputation: Your Commitment Certificate and (if you choose) a Zero Cube assessment show early climate seriousness.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 4 · BUSINESS

MSME Member Benefits proposed

₹30,000 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Micro, small and medium enterprises, especially suppliers to large buyers

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Annual Scope 3 / supplier-readiness diagnostic
- 2 staff seats in the MSME Scope 3 learning series
- Supplier emissions-data templates
- Members-only sessions (e.g. Scope 3 clinics, expert Q&A)
- Optional independent verification, paid directly to the verifier (never a fee increase)

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Business: An annual Scope 3 / supplier-readiness diagnostic and emissions-data templates help you answer the climate questions large buyers now ask.

Career: Two staff seats in the Scope 3 learning series build in-house skills.

Reputation: Be ready with data; optional third-party verification can be added later, paid directly to the verifier.

Impact: Cutting energy and waste on the shop floor lowers cost and emissions together.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 5 · INSTITUTIONS

Institution / School Member Proposed

₹10,000 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Private schools, colleges, training institutes (government & low-fee schools: free or sliding scale)

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- School climate-literacy toolkit and teacher orientation
- Certified Net Zero School pathway at member rates
- Members-only sessions; bulletin and magazine
- Want the whole-school programme? See Green School Partner

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Impact: A climate-literacy toolkit and teacher orientation bring climate and equal learning into classrooms.

Reputation: A Certified Net Zero School pathway at member rates (proposed) gives the school a clear, evidence-based story for parents.

Career: Climate Academy courses stay free for students and faculty, as for everyone; membership adds the toolkit, teacher orientation and members-only sessions.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	As per fee card. Government and low-fee schools: free or sliding scale; village schools never pay.	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 6 · PEOPLE

Education Champion Proposed

₹500 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Teachers, professors and tutors who pledge to find and teach students (teachers in government and low-fee schools: free, sponsor-funded)

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Teaching kit and Zero Cube climate-education modules for your classes
- “Climate Educator” digital badge
- Your students counted on the Wall of Honour under your education pledge
- Members-only sessions (2 a month) and an educators' peer circle
- Commitment Certificate for your pledge, including your education pledge

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Career: A teaching kit, climate-education modules and the “Climate Educator” badge you can show on a CV or LinkedIn (badge system Planned).

Reputation: Your students are counted on the Wall of Honour under your education pledge, so your teaching is visible.

Impact: You find and teach students yourself — the education pledge turned into real classes. Government and low-fee school teachers join free (sponsor-funded).

Free for teachers in government and low-fee schools (sponsor-funded). Students under 18 are counted, never named, on public walls without parent/guardian consent.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 7 · PEOPLE

Student Sponsor Proposed

₹1,500 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Per individual or family: people who fund students' learning — directly, or through verified NPO projects

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Zero Cube never handles sponsorship money: you pay the student, school or NPO directly; this fee covers membership services only
- Student Sponsor certificate
- Impact updates on the students or projects you support (as reported by the school or NPO)
- Recognition as an education philanthropist on the Wall of Honour (opt-in)
- Help finding verified routes, including NPO projects on Verified Projects

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Impact: You fund students directly, or through verified NPO projects; every rupee of the sponsorship goes to the student, school or NPO — never to Zero Cube.

Reputation: A Student Sponsor certificate and opt-in recognition as an education philanthropist on the Wall of Honour.

Leadership: Impact updates (as reported by the school or NPO) help you grow from one student to many — step 4 of the path to philanthropy.

Zero Cube never handles sponsorship money. The ₹1,500 fee pays only for membership services. The sponsorship itself is paid separately and directly to the student, school or verified NPO; any tax receipt comes from that recipient. The fee is not a donation and not eligible for 80G. **CS/CA to confirm** GST and this wording.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 8 · INSTITUTIONS

Green School Partner Proposed

₹25,000 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Schools and colleges taking up the whole-school programme (government & low-fee schools: free or sliding scale; CSR can fund the programme, never the membership fee)

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- The higher programme tier: includes all Institution / School Member benefits
- Climate curriculum support and whole-school teacher orientation
- Student-led green audits of energy, water, waste and transport
- Eco-club or campus chapter, set up with our support
- Path to Zero Cube Green School certification (assessed under Zero Cube's own criteria; assessment as per fee card)
- Institution / School Members can upgrade by paying the difference

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Impact: A whole-school programme: climate curriculum support, student-led green audits of energy, water, waste and transport, and an eco-club or campus chapter.

Reputation: A clear path to Zero Cube Green School certification (assessed under our own criteria) — a story parents and inspectors can check.

Career: Includes all Institution / School Member benefits, such as the climate-literacy toolkit and members-only sessions.

How it relates to the Institution / School Member tier: Institution / School Member (₹10,000) is the entry membership — toolkit, teacher orientation and members-only sessions (Climate Academy courses are free for everyone). Green School Partner is the higher whole-school programme and includes all Institution benefits; an Institution member can upgrade by paying the difference. Green School certification is assessed under Zero Cube's own criteria (assessment as per fee card) — it is not a third-party certification.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	As per fee card. Government and low-fee schools: free or sliding scale; CSR can fund the programme, never the membership fee.	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 9 · INSTITUTIONS

0^3 Foundation Member

To be confirmed

₹10,000 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Organisations that are not schools or businesses, e.g. associations

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Bulletin and magazine
- Members-only sessions (2 a month)
- Online networking with other members (being built)

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Impact: For associations and organisations that are not schools or businesses: members-only sessions, the bulletin and networking to build climate capability.

Reputation: Membership shows your organisation takes part in measured climate and education work.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 10 · INSTITUTIONS

NPO Member — Verified Projects

Final fees announced soon

From ₹1,500 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Registered NPOs in India, priced by size. Village-level community groups: free.

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- One annual fee covering everything on this card — no commission
- Verification and "Zero Cube Verified" badge
- Approved project listings with your own donate link
- Reporting templates; reports published
- An annual SROI / impact report showing donors the social value per ₹1, mapped to the SDGs; dMRV indicators where relevant
- Fundraising & CSR-readiness training

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Business: Verification, a "Zero Cube Verified" badge and project listings with your own donate link — donors pay you directly; no commission.

Reputation: An annual SROI / impact report shows donors the social value per ₹1, mapped to the SDGs.

Impact: Reporting templates and CSR-readiness training help you raise and use funds well.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 11 · BUSINESS

Eco-Product Manufacturer Member Proposed

₹20,000 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Makers of eco-friendly or low-carbon products

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Eco-Product Directory listing after screening ("Listed — not certified")
- Claim-language guidance against greenwashing
- Members-only sessions (2 a month); bulletin and magazine

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Business: An Eco-Product Directory listing after screening ("Listed — not certified") puts your products in front of buyers.

Reputation: Claim-language guidance helps you avoid greenwashing.

Career: Members-only sessions; your team learns free in the Climate Academy, like everyone.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 12 · VILLAGES & CLUBS

Certified Network Member

Free

WHO IT IS FOR

Certified clubs, Gram Panchayats and future certified bodies. Villages never pay.

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Network badge; listing on the public certificate register
- Peer-learning circle; bulletin and magazine

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Impact: For certified clubs and Gram Panchayats. Villages never pay and need no membership for village certification, which is funded through CSR.

Reputation: A network badge and a listing on the public certificate register.

Impact: A peer-learning circle to share what works, village to village.

Fee as on the current fee card. An earlier plan draft proposed a club fee from Year 2; the site's "Free" is used here — Board to confirm.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Village Net Zero certification at no cost to the village — CSR-funded; no membership needed.	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 13 · PEOPLE

Expert / Volunteer Associate

No fee — give time

WHO IT IS FOR

Practitioners, assessors, faculty, retired professionals

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Recognition as Associate — a philanthropist of time and expertise
- Assessor/reviewer training (with COI declaration)
- Certificate of hours
- Paid only when engaged on a project

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Career: Recognition as an Associate, assessor/reviewer training (with a conflict-of-interest declaration) and a certificate of hours.

Reputation: Your expertise is used where it counts and recognised publicly (opt-in).

Impact: Mentor, train and review — giving time instead of money.

No fee. Associates sign a volunteer agreement and a conflict-of-interest declaration; anyone assessing a project does not advise it (CS/legal to confirm agreement terms).

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 14 · BUSINESS

Corporate Climate Partner — Supporter

₹50,000 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Companies and large MSMEs

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Logo on partners page as “Climate Partner”
- 2 seats in the MSME/Scope 3 learning series
- Quarterly impact note on the programmes you fund; 1 employee-volunteering day

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Business: Two seats in the MSME / Scope 3 learning series and a quarterly impact note on the programmes you fund.

Reputation: Your logo on the partners page as a “Climate Partner”.

Impact: An employee-volunteering day connects your team to real field work.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 15 · BUSINESS

Corporate Climate Partner — Partner Proposed

₹2,00,000 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Mid and large companies

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Supporter benefits plus a named village or school cohort update (education / village outcomes)
- Supplier (Scope 3) awareness session for up to 10 suppliers

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Business: A supplier (Scope 3) awareness session for up to 10 suppliers.

Reputation: Supporter benefits plus a named village or school cohort update.

Impact: Education and village outcomes you can follow over time.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 16 · BUSINESS

Corporate Climate Partner — Champion Proposed

₹5,00,000 / year

WHO IT IS FOR

Large companies and anchor partners

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Partner benefits plus a seat on a non-voting Industry Advisory Panel
- Co-branded annual programme report with impact results; Scope 3 supplier cohort of up to 25

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Business: A Scope 3 supplier cohort of up to 25 and a seat on a non-voting Industry Advisory Panel.

Reputation: A co-branded annual programme report with impact results.

Impact: Anchor-level support for programmes at scale.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 17 · PEOPLE

Lifetime Supporter

₹1,00,000 one-time

WHO IT IS FOR

Individuals committed long-term

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Lifetime Individual Supporter benefits (members-only sessions, bulletin and magazine)
- Founding Supporter recognition
- Annual meet invitation

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Reputation: Founding Supporter recognition and lifetime individual benefits — one payment, no renewals.

Impact: Long-term backing for measured climate and education work.

Career: Annual meet invitation to stay connected with the ecosystem.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

TIER 18 · PEOPLE

Patron / Founding Circle Proposed

₹2,50,000+ · interest only for now

WHO IT IS FOR

Philanthropists, family offices, founders' networks

WHAT YOU GET (FROM THE FEE CARD)

- Recognition: Founding Circle wall (opt-in)
- Annual Patron briefing; NetZero village site visit
- Founding Circle limited to the first 10 Patrons
- A donation, not a fee; recognition only
- Interest only for now: no contribution is accepted until our bank account and the required approvals are in place

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Reputation: Recognition on the Founding Circle wall (opt-in), limited to the first 10 Patrons.

Impact: An annual Patron briefing and a NetZero village site visit to see the work first-hand.

Leadership: A natural home for members who have grown from pledge to philanthropy.

CS/legal to confirm — donation treatment. The fee card lists Patron as a "Donation ₹2,50,000+". The plan treats Patron gifts with recognition only as donations (80G only after approval). Adding the Commitment Certificate and Net Zero audit as Patron benefits may make it a payment with benefits, and Zero Cube's model is that giving goes directly to verified NPOs, students and schools. How a Patron contribution is received, receipted and treated must be confirmed by the CS/CA before launch. No 80G claim is made.

Commitment Certificate	Net Zero audit	Wall of Honour	Pledge Ledger
Free with active membership once your pledge is Approved on the ledger. Certifies commitment, not results.	Register interest from My Pledge; fee as per fee card. Villages never pay (CSR-funded; no membership needed).	Opt-in listing of approved pledges and members. Opens at launch.	Each certificate has its own ledger entry anyone can check (genesis pending; starts at launch).

Prices before GST; some tiers subject to Board approval. Fees are not eligible for 80G. Tier tags (Proposed, Benefits proposed, To be confirmed, Final fees announced soon) are as shown on the fee card.

4 From member to philanthropist

Most philanthropists start small. This is the path we want to make easy — and visible.

1
Pledge
Take the free Climate Duty Pledge and set personal or organisational actions.

Pledge ID on the Ledger; Wall of Honour (opt-in)

2
Member
Join any tier. Unlock the Commitment Certificate and Net Zero audit interest.

Member badge; certificate with QR

3
Volunteer / expert
Give time: Webinar Crew, Field Data Contributor, campus chapter, or Expert / Volunteer Associate.

Certificate of hours; badges Learner → Contributor → Champion

4
Giver / mentor
Fund a verified NPO project, a student or a school directly, and mentor students or MSMEs.

Giver badge; mentor recognition; your name in the annual impact story (opt-in)

5
Patron / leader
Join the Founding Circle (first 10 Patrons), lead a chapter, or serve on a non-voting advisory panel.

Founding Circle wall; annual Patron briefing; village site visit

Zero Cube never collects donations to pass on. When you give, the money goes **directly** to the verified NPO (through its own donate link on Verified Projects), the student or the school. Zero Cube verifies, reports and recognises — it does not hold or pool your gift, and takes no commission.

Recognition ideas

Idea	How it works	Status
Digital badges	Learner → Contributor → Champion for students; Member, Volunteer, Giver, Mentor and Patron badges for all. Can be added to LinkedIn as a certification.	Planned
Wall of Honour	Opt-in wall of approved pledges, members, givers and Patrons (Founding Circle section).	Prototype opens at launch
Annual impact story	Each year, members who opt in get a short story: hours given, actions completed, projects supported directly — verified where possible, self-declared otherwise.	Planned
Certificate of hours	For volunteers and Expert / Volunteer Associates.	On fee card; issuing system Planned
Annual meet recognition	Recognition at the annual Climate & Social Impact meet for outstanding volunteers, mentors and givers.	Planned

CS/legal to confirm: any recognition linked to giving must not be a benefit "bought" with a donation; 80G will be stated only after approval; minors are recognised only with parent/guardian consent and first name only.

5 Online networking benefits

Membership should connect people who can help each other. These are the online benefits — most are still being built.

Benefit	What it does	Status
Member directory	Find and contact other members by sector, city and skill (opt-in profiles).	Planned
Collaboration board	Post and answer asks and offers: experts, MSME vendors, schools and villages looking for help or partners.	Planned
Public webinars and Climate Academy	Free awareness webinars and self-paced online courses on Net Zero, SROI and education — free for everyone, not a member benefit.	Live
Members-only sessions	Twice a month for paying tiers, e.g. Scope 3 clinics and expert Q&A.	Planned
Campus chapters	Student-led chapters with Webinar Crew and Action Labs; safeguarding rules for minors.	Planned
LinkedIn badges	Add your Commitment Certificate or badge to LinkedIn under “Licenses & certifications”, linking to your Ledger entry.	Planned
MSME buyer–supplier connections	Introduce MSME members to corporate partners’ Scope 3 supplier programmes (Partner: up to 10 suppliers; Champion: cohort of up to 25).	Planned
Eco-Product Directory	Screened listing of eco-products (“Listed — not certified”).	Planned
My Pledge account	Track your pledge, certificate, audit interest and membership link.	Prototype
Bulletin and magazine	Regular updates on SROI, education and Net Zero work.	Planned

Ground rules for networking

- Profiles are opt-in; contact details are shared only with consent.
- No selling to minors; campus chapters follow a safeguarding policy, with parent/guardian consent for under-18s.
- Introductions are not endorsements. Zero Cube takes no commission on any deal between members.
- Related-party listings (for example, firms linked to directors) are disclosed and handled under the conflict-of-interest policy.

CS/legal to confirm: data-protection notice under the DPDP Act for the directory and board, and the related-party disclosure wording.

6 Global benchmarks — what we learned

We studied how well-known networks reward members. We kept what fits a small, Indian, measurement-first foundation.

Network	What members get there	What Zero Cube adapts	Source
Rotary International	Clubs where members discuss community needs, connect and build leadership and professional skills; Fellowships and Action Groups; Foundation grants for projects. Global network of 1.2 million members.	Campus chapters and expert circles; leadership roles in the pathway; project funding stays direct to verified NPOs.	[1][2][3]
Lions Clubs International	Service in local clubs, leadership training and personal growth, LCIF grants, plus Member Perks discounts. 1.4 million members in more than 49,000 clubs.	Service roles with measured outcomes; leadership training for Associates. No consumer discounts — fees stay all-inclusive.	[4][5]
The Giving Pledge	A public promise to give the majority of wealth, made with a pledge letter; peer learning and an annual gathering. It is not a pooled fund and does not distribute money — pledgers give independently. 250+ pledgers from 30 countries (Nov 2025).	The free Climate Duty Pledge with a public Ledger entry; the giver stage where money goes directly to verified NPOs, students and schools; a Patron learning circle.	[6][7]
Climate Reality Project	Leadership Corps training (multi-day), a global community and advocacy skills; leaders commit to "Acts of Leadership" after training (10 in the first 12 months in the Australian branch's guidelines).	Train-then-act model for Student and Volunteer roles; badge points for completed actions.	[8][9]
B Corp community (B Lab)	B Hive online community to connect, find resources, a directory and marketplace with member offers; local B Local groups.	Member directory and collaboration board; MSME buyer–supplier connections.	[10][11]
UN Global Compact	Participants get networking, tools and trainings, and Local Networks in 60+ countries; over 20,000 business participants.	Practical tools and trainings for MSMEs. Zero Cube is not a participant and claims no UN partnership.	[12]
ISEAL (sustainability systems)	Members get peer learning, technical working groups, training discounts; the ISEAL Code of Good Practice covers standard-setting, assurance, monitoring and claims.	Our criteria aim to follow ISEAL-style good practice: separate standard-setting from assessment, clear claim rules, monitoring. No ISEAL membership or compliance is claimed.	[13][14]
iVolunteer (India)	Matches volunteers to verified NGOs; a volunteer dashboard and downloadable volunteer history; no fee for volunteers; national iVolunteer Awards.	Certificate of hours and a volunteer history in My Pledge (Planned); annual recognition.	[15][16]
CII and IGBC (India)	CII: networking, members' directory, B2B opportunities, online communities and webinars. IGBC (part of CII): networking, local chapters, discounts on programmes and certification fees, logo use.	Members' directory and B2B-style buyer–supplier connections; local chapters later. No certification discounts — fees stay all-inclusive.	[17][18]
FICCI Centre for Sustainability Leadership	A sustainability platform focused on capacity building, decarbonisation and supply chains, with attention to SMEs.	The MSME Scope 3 learning series and supplier cohorts.	[19]

Figures are as stated on each organisation's own pages (accessed Oct 2026); see References. Naming these organisations is for comparison only — Zero Cube has no partnership, membership or MoU with any of them.

Education tiers — how we set the proposed fees (Oct 2026)

Programme	What it is	Published fee	Source
Eco-Schools India (FEE programme run by CEE)	School programme; Green Flag certification	Application ₹295 (incl. GST) + programme fee ₹18,000 + GST per cycle (2023–24 flyer); government-recognised schools exempt. Current cycle fee: ask CEE.	[25][26]
Eco-Schools international (FEE, direct registration)	International schools without a national operator	€1,000 for 2 years (€500/yr); Green Flag assessment €400	[27]
GRIHA for Existing Schools	Green rating of an existing school	₹70,000 + GST per project (+₹10,000 optional feasibility study)	[28]
IGBC Green Schools	Green school building rating	Registration ₹25,000 + certification ₹1,75,000 (+ GST)	[29]
British Council RIDS (formerly ISA)	Whole-school international dimension programme	₹74,000 + GST per cycle; certification valid 3 years	[30]
Round Square	Global network of schools	Annual subscription by formula; not published (candidate schools pay 65%)	[31]
WWF-India One Planet Academy / Wild Wisdom	Free digital learning; school quiz	Free platform; no registration fee for Wild Wisdom	[32][33]
Rotary Interact clubs	School clubs sponsored by Rotary clubs	Rotary International requires no dues; some clubs set small local dues	[34]
NAAEE (North America)	Environmental educators' association	Professional (incl. K–12 teachers) US$80/yr; student US$35; nonprofit/educational institution US$400/yr	[35]
AIFTO (All India Federation of Teachers' Organisations)	Federation of state teacher unions	No individual fee published (members join through state affiliates)	[36]
Teach For India US (benchmark for sponsorship, not a fee)	Donations for Fellows	US$9,000 supports 1 Fellow teaching 35+ students for a year	[37]

Proposed tier	Proposed fee	Why this fee
Education Champion	₹500 / year (free for teachers in government and low-fee schools, sponsor-funded)	Teachers give their time, as Expert Associates do; the fee only covers the kit and badge. Half the Student fee and far below NAAEE's US$80 professional rate, so cost is never a barrier.
Student Sponsor	₹1,500 / year per individual or family	Below the Individual Supporter fee (₹2,500), because the member's real giving goes directly to students. The fee covers routes, certificate and impact updates only — never the sponsorship.
Green School Partner	₹25,000 / year (government and low-fee schools: free or sliding scale; CSR can fund the programme, never the membership fee)	A whole-school programme that includes the ₹10,000 Institution tier; above Eco-Schools India (₹18,000 + GST per cycle) and well below GRIHA (₹70,000), RIDS (₹74,000) or IGBC (₹2,00,000).

Fees as published on each organisation's own pages (accessed 18 Oct 2026); where a fee is not published we say so. Zero Cube has no partnership, membership or MoU with any of them. The three education tiers are **Proposed** — Board to approve; existing fees are unchanged.

7 Credibility: how assessments work

Members and buyers need to trust the results. Here is how we keep our work honest.

Methods we follow

Standard	What it is for
GHG Protocol Corporate Standard and Scope 3 Standard	How to count an organisation's emissions across Scope 1, 2 and 3 (supply chain). It sets accounting rules, not how verification is done.
ISO 14064-1:2018	Quantifying and reporting greenhouse gas emissions and removals at organisation level.
ISO 14064-3:2019	Used by independent verification bodies to verify or validate greenhouse gas statements.
ISO 14068:2026 (carbon neutrality)	Reduce first, then address the rest; replaced ISO 14068-1:2023 in September 2026.

dMRV: digital measurement, reporting and verification

We collect activity data digitally — electricity and fuel bills, meter readings, purchase and travel records, and field data from members (for example Field Data Contributors) — and keep a record of every number and its evidence. Calculations follow the methods above. dMRV makes the work faster and easier to check; it does not by itself make a result "verified".

How we certify: AI-first, then a human verifier

Step	What happens
1 · AI-first review	Your pledge, data and evidence are first checked by our AI tools for completeness and consistency.
2 · Human verifier	A trained Zero Cube verifier reviews the result and decides. Nothing is certified by AI alone.
3 · Optional independent verification	An independent verification body accredited under ISO 14065 can verify the claim. Paid directly to the verifier by MSMEs, or through CSR for villages. It never increases the membership fee.

Two levels — know which one you have

Zero Cube assessed

An **assessment under our own criteria**, using GHG Protocol / ISO 14064 / ISO 14068 methods and dMRV evidence. Included as described on the fee card (audit fee as per fee card; villages never pay).

It is not independent verification by an accredited body.

Optional third-party verification

An independent verification body (accredited under ISO 14065) chosen by the client checks the statement, for example under ISO 14064-3.

- **Villages:** paid through CSR — never by the village.
- **MSMEs:** pay the verifier directly. Zero Cube does not collect this fee.
- **Group rates** only after a signed MoU with a verifier. No such MoU exists today.

Safeguards

- No one assesses a project they advised; assessors sign a conflict-of-interest declaration.
- Claims guidance: "Zero Cube assessed" or "Pledge on Ledger" — never "carbon neutral" or "third-party verified" unless that is actually true.
- Commitment Certificates certify commitment, not results.

No membership fee increase. Assessments, certificates and Ledger checks are delivered within current fees. Third-party verification, when chosen, is a separate cost paid directly to the verifier (or through CSR for villages).

CS/CA to confirm: wording of assessment reports and claims, verifier engagement terms, and GST on audit fees.

8 मराठी सारांश

झिरो क्यूब सदस्यत्व लाभ मार्गदर्शिका — थोडक्यात

प्रतिज्ञा आणि सदस्यत्व

- सर्व वेबिनार आणि क्लायमेट अकॅडमीचे ऑनलाइन कोर्सेस **सर्वांसाठी मोफत** आहेत. सदस्यत्व शुल्क ज्ञानासाठी नाही, तर प्रत्यक्ष सहभाग, सदस्यांसाठी सत्रे, कमिटमेंट सर्टिफिकेट, ऑडिट, नेटवर्किंग आणि ओळख यांसाठी आहे.
- क्लायमेट ड्युटी प्रतिज्ञा सर्वांसाठी **मोफत** आहे.
- १८ पैकी **कोणत्याही** सदस्यत्व श्रेणीचे सक्रिय सदस्य झाल्यावर आणि प्रतिज्ञा मंजूर झाल्यावर दोन लाभ खुले होतात: **कमिटमेंट सर्टिफिकेट** आणि **नेट झिरो ऑडिटसाठी इच्छा नोंदवणे**.
- सर्टिफिकेट तुमच्या **वचनबद्धतेचे** आहे, प्रत्यक्ष परिणामांचे नाही. ऑडिट शुल्क फी कार्डनुसार; **गावांना कधीही शुल्क नाही आणि सदस्यत्वाची गरज नाही** — गावांच्या प्रमाणपत्राचा खर्च CSR मधून होतो. CSR निधीतून सदस्यत्व शुल्क भरता येत नाही.
- वॉल ऑफ ऑनर (इच्छेनुसार; सुरुवातीनंतर) आणि प्लेज लेजरवर कोणीही तुमची प्रतिज्ञा तपासू शकतो.
- सध्या कोणतेही शुल्क घेतले जात नाही — बँक खाते सुरू झाल्यावर सदस्यत्व शुल्क स्वीकारले जाईल. फाउंडिंग मेंबर्स प्रतीक्षा यादीत नाव नोंदवा.
- सध्याच्या श्रेणींचे शुल्क बदललेले नाही. शिक्षणासाठी तीन नवीन श्रेणी प्रस्तावित आहेत: एज्युकेशन चॅम्पियन (₹५००), स्टुडंट स्पॉन्सर (₹१,५००) आणि ग्रीन स्कूल पार्टनर (₹२५,०००; सरकारी शाळांसाठी मोफत). सदस्यत्व शुल्क 80G साठी पात्र नाही.

सदस्य ते दाता — पाच पायऱ्या

प्रतिज्ञा → सदस्य → स्वयंसेवक / तज्ज्ञ → दाता / मार्गदर्शक → पॅट्रन / नेतृत्व. **झिरो क्यूब देणग्या गोळा करत नाही;** तुमची मदत थेट पडताळलेल्या संस्था, विद्यार्थी आणि शाळांपर्यंत जाते. ओळख: डिजिटल बॅज, वॉल ऑफ ऑनर, वार्षिक इम्पॅक्ट स्टोरी (नियोजित).

ऑनलाइन नेटवर्किंग (बहुतेक नियोजित)

सदस्य निर्देशिका, सहयोग फलक (तज्ज्ञ, MSME पुरवठादार, शाळा, गावे), मोफत वेबिनार आणि सदस्यांसाठी सत्रे, कॅम्पस चॅप्टर, LinkedIn बॅज, MSME साठी खरेदीदार–पुरवठादार जोडणी.

विश्वासार्हता

प्रमाणन आधी AI द्वारे तपासणी, नंतर मानवी पडताळणी. dMRV (डिजिटल मोजमाप) आधारित मूल्यांकन GHG Protocol, ISO 14064 आणि ISO 14068 पद्धतींनुसार. "झिरो क्यूब मूल्यांकित" म्हणजे आमच्या स्वतःच्या निकषांनुसार मूल्यांकन. त्रयस्थ (थर्ड-पार्टी, ISO 14065 मान्यताप्राप्त) पडताळणी ऐच्छिक आहे — गावांसाठी खर्च CSR करते; MSME थेट पडताळणी संस्थेला शुल्क देतात; सदस्यत्व शुल्क वाढत नाही. सामूहिक दर फक्त स्वाक्षरी केलेल्या सामंजस्य करारानंतर (MoU).

> कायदेशीर मुद्दे CS/CA यांच्या पुष्टीनंतरच अंतिम होतील. 80G चा कोणताही दावा केलेला नाही. पॅट्रन योगदान "देणगी" म्हणून कसे हाताळायचे — CS/कायदेशीर सल्ल्यानंतर ठरेल.

Marathi summary of sections 1–7. To be reviewed by a native Marathi editor before printing.

9 Legal notes and open points

Plain list of what still needs a professional sign-off before this guide is used publicly.

Point	Position in this guide	Owner
80G / 12A	No 80G or 12A claim is made. Membership fees are payments for services, not donations.	CS/CA to confirm
Soft launch	No payment is collected now. Membership payments open once the bank account is active; until then the Founding Members waitlist only records interest.	Director
CSR and membership fees	CSR funds can pay for programmes such as village certification, never for membership fees.	CS/CA to confirm
Patron / Founding Circle	Fee card says "Donation ₹2,50,000+" but the tier now also carries pledge benefits, while our model says giving goes directly to verified NPOs, students and schools. How Patron money is received and treated is open.	CS/legal to confirm
Donate page	The website donate page shows "Donations — coming soon" and accepts nothing yet. When it opens, it must stay aligned with "Zero Cube never collects donations to pass on".	Director + CS/legal
Certified Network fee	Guide uses the fee card: "Free". An earlier plan proposed ₹2,500 a year for clubs from Year 2.	Board to confirm
NPO fee bands	Fee card: "From ₹1,500 / year · final fees announced soon". Options A/B/C (document 10) are still to be decided.	Director / Board
Proposed tiers	Tiers tagged Proposed / To be confirmed / Final fees announced soon are subject to Board approval.	Board
Education tiers (new)	Education Champion ₹500, Student Sponsor ₹1,500, Green School Partner ₹25,000 — all Proposed. Student Sponsor fees cover services only; sponsorship goes directly to the student, school or NPO and is never received by Zero Cube.	Board; CS/CA to confirm
GST	Prices before GST.	CA to confirm
Certificate & audit terms	Draft terms version g (sections 7C/7D).	CS/legal to confirm
Minors	Parent/guardian consent; first name only on public walls; no photos; safeguarding policy for chapters.	CS/legal to confirm
Data protection	Opt-in directory and wall; DPDP Act notice needed before launch.	CS/legal to confirm
Partners and MoUs	No MoU has been signed yet. No partner, verifier or platform partnership is claimed. Group verification rates only after a signed MoU.	Director
Related parties	Any listing of a director-linked firm is disclosed as a related party.	CS to confirm

Zero Cube Climate & Social Impact Foundation — Section 8 company, incorporated 28 September 2026. CIN U88900PN2026NPL260913 · PAN AADCZ1959P · TAN PNEZ19354G. Directors: Saurabh Muralidhar Somani, Rajendrakumar Saraf. Contact: zerocubecif@gmail.com

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